



AWS CERTIFIED SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT PROFESSIONAL EXAM OVERVIEW

SAP-C02 Exam Details

The AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (SAP-C02) exam is one of the two Professional-level certification tests of the AWS Certification program. This particular exam is meant for individuals who perform a solutions architect role in their current company/organization. The SAP-C02 exam validates the person's general IT knowledge, advanced technical skills, and experience in designing optimized AWS solutions that are based on the AWS Well-Architected Framework.

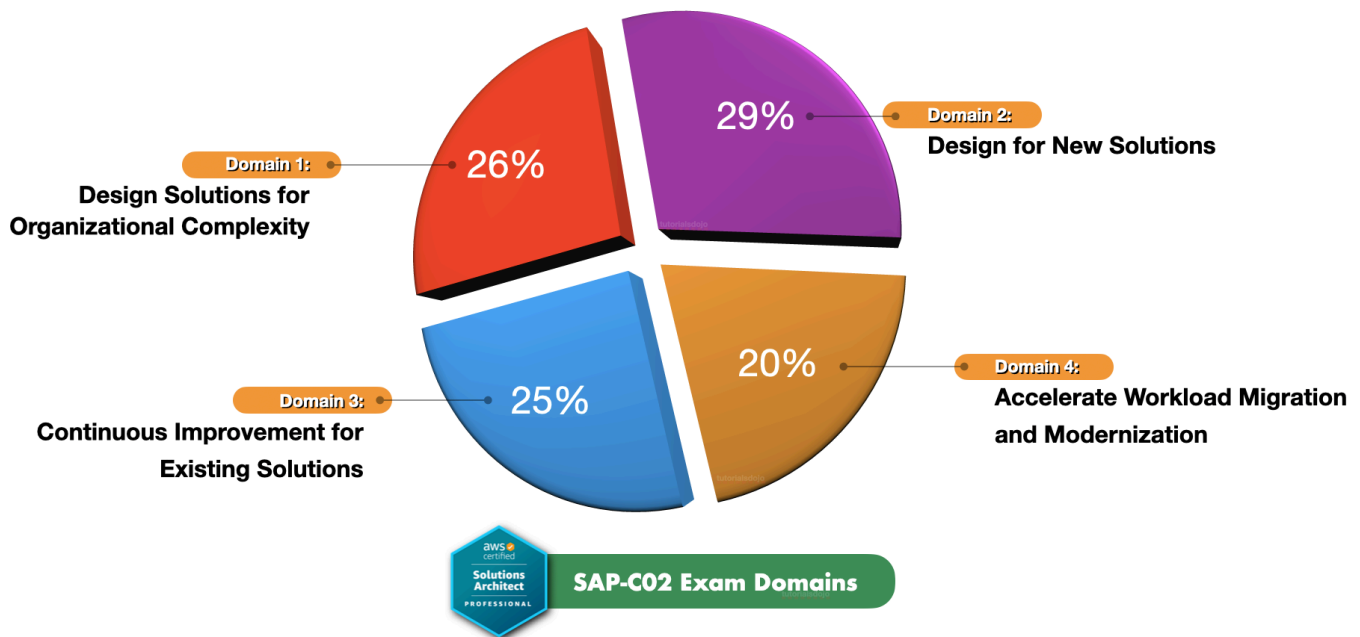
This Pro-level certification exam is composed of 75 multiple-choice or multiple-response scenario-based questions that you must complete within 180 minutes or 3 hours. The “multiple-choice” question type has one correct answer and three incorrect responses, while the “multiple response” item has two or more right responses out of five or more options. Like other AWS certification exams, you can take the SAP-C02 exam from a local testing center or online from your home.

Exam Code:	SAP-C02
Release Date:	November 2022
Prerequisites:	None
No. of Questions:	75
Score Range:	100 - 1000
Cost:	300 USD
Passing Score:	750/1000
Time Limit:	3 hours (180 minutes)
Format:	Scenario-based. Multiple choice/multiple answers.
Delivery Method:	Testing center or online proctored exam.

The AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (SAP-C02) exam has no prerequisites, so you can take this exam directly. The score range is from 100 to 1000 and you need to score at least 750 to pass the test. Thus, the passing score is at 75% (750/1000) compared with just 72% for the Associate-level exams.

Exam Domains

The AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional (SAP-C02) exam has 4 different domains, each with corresponding weight and topic coverage. The exam domains are as follows: Design Solutions for Organizational Complexity (26%), Design for New Solutions (29%), Continuous Improvement for Existing Solutions (25%) and lastly, Accelerate Workload Migration and Modernization (20%):



The list of exam domains can be found on the [official Exam Guide for the AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional exam](#). Each exam domain is comprised of several task statements. A task statement is a sub-category of the exam domain that contains the necessary topics, knowledge, concepts, and skills for you to accomplish a particular task or activity in AWS.

As seen in the above pie graph, the first domain covers 26% of the overall test while the second domain covers 29%, which represents the biggest chunk of the exam. This is followed by the third and fourth domains with 25% and 20% coverage, respectively.

Let's look at each of these domains one by one.



Domain 1: Design Solutions for Organizational Complexity

The first exam domain is all about checking your knowledge in properly setting up cloud architectures for large organizations with multiple business units. You have to be knowledgeable in launching and maintaining a centralized cloud organization with multiple AWS accounts across several geographical regions using the AWS Organizations service as well the other governance and management services. This includes the skill of setting up cost-effective, resilient and reliable network connectivity for your hybrid cloud and shared AWS resources.

This is the second biggest domain in the exam with 26% percent coverage; therefore, you must allocate significant time to study the various concepts covered in this domain. It also includes the security posture of your cloud solutions to ensure that they conform with the guardrails and regulations of your organization.

The series of scenarios that you will encounter in this domain checks your know-how in doing these tasks:

- Architect network connectivity strategies.
- Prescribe security controls.
- Design reliable and resilient architectures.
- Design a multi-account AWS environment.
- Determine cost optimization and visibility strategies.

Domain 2: Design for New Solutions

The second exam domain ("Design Resilient Architectures") is all about designing resilient architectures in AWS. It is the biggest domain in the exam, with 29% percent coverage so you must also allocate a lot of time to understand the different concepts covered in this domain.

The questions that you will encounter in this domain will challenge your knowledge in:

- Design a deployment strategy to meet business requirements.
- Design a solution to ensure business continuity.
- Determine security controls based on requirements.
- Design a strategy to meet reliability requirements.
- Design a solution to meet performance objectives.
- Determine a cost optimization strategy to meet solution goals and objectives.



Domain 3: Continuous Improvement for Existing Solutions

The third domain is all about continuously improving your existing cloud solutions in AWS. This has an exam coverage of 25 percent and revolves around improving the security, performance, reliability and overall operational excellence of your solutions. It also includes the topic of cost optimization and the skill involved to easily identify them on an existing cloud architecture. You should prepare for:

- Determine a strategy to improve overall operational excellence.
- Determine a strategy to improve security.
- Determine a strategy to improve performance.
- Determine a strategy to improve reliability
- Identify opportunities for cost optimizations.

Domain 4: Accelerate Workload Migration and Modernization

The last exam domain revolves around designing cost-optimized architectures. It comprises 20% of the exam coverage, so you have to limit the time you spend reviewing the concepts under this domain. As you might have guessed, this domain is all about the costs of your cloud architecture and the different ways to reduce operational expenditures. This domain checks if you possess the knowledge in doing following tasks:

- Select existing workloads and processes for potential migration
- Determine the optimal migration approach for existing workloads.
- Determine a new architecture for existing workloads.
- Determine opportunities for modernization and enhancements.

These are the four exam domains that you should be familiar with when you start your exam preparations. Again, the SAP-C02 exam is primarily focused on security, so make sure that you focus on the “Design Solutions for Organizational Complexity” domain and all the related knowledge areas in its task statements.

I highly recommend that you read the [official exam guide](#) for the AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional exam from cover to cover. Pay close attention to the topics included, and don't forget to read the Appendix section, which contains a list of related AWS services that will appear in the exam.



The Old SAP-C01 and New SAP-C02 Exam Difference

The SAP-C02 is the 3rd iteration of the AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional exam, which was initially launched about a decade ago. The very first version of this certification test was released on May 2014 with an exam code of SAP-C00. AWS released the second version on February 2019, which is 5 years from the first one, with an exam code of SAP-C01. The third, and also the latest, exam version of the AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional exam has an exam code of SAP-C02 which became available on November 15, 2022.

I've already taken and passed the previous versions of this exam in the past, but this week, I took the latest exam version to ensure that our SAP-C02 reviewers here at Tutorials Dojo are still on par with the actual exam. I took the first version of this test (SAP-C00) in April 2018, which is almost 5 years from today, and then the second exam version (SAP-C01) in February 2019. I took the recently launched SAP-C02 exam version on November 2022.

It's noticeable that the length of time for the SAP-C01 version to be replaced with the new SAP-C02 is 3 years. Based on this trend, I'm assuming that the 4th iteration of this certification test will be coming in 2025, with an exam code of SAP-C03. This is just a rough estimation as it depends on the number of feature changes and brand-new services that AWS releases.

Through all these exam iterations, I would say that there were significant changes from the first SAP-C00 exam compared with the second version (SAP-C01). Back in 2018, when I took the SAP-C00 exam, the questions were long, but the number of AWS services included was not that extensive. It was when AWS released the SAP-C01 exam version where the AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional exam topics covered a wide range of AWS services and other 3rd party systems.

The SAP-C02 still resembles the old format of the recently decommissioned SAP-C01 exam. It has a mix of long questions (with 3-4 paragraphs) and short ones (1-2 paragraphs). The same goes for the answers as well, with multiple-response questions where you have to select 2 or 3 items out of 5 or 6 options. In comparison with the SAA-C03 and other Associate-level exams, the AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional exam has significantly more multiple-response questions than multiple-choice items.

SAP-C01 Valid until November 14, 2022		aws certified Solutions Architect PROFESSIONAL	SAP-C02 NEW Available on November 15, 2022	
DOMAIN	% of Examination		DOMAIN	% of Examination
Design for Organizational Complexity	12.5%	→	Design Solutions for Organizational Complexity	26%
Design for New Solutions	31%	→	Design for New Solutions	29%
Migration Planning	15%	→	Accelerate Workload Migration & Modernization	20%
Cost Control	12.5%	→	REMOVED	
Continuous Improvement	29%	→	Continuous Improvement for Existing Solutions	25%

- There is no BETA exam for the SAP-C02 exam version

The table above shows the difference between the SAP-C01 exam domains versus the new SAP-C02 exam. From 5 exam domains, it is now down to 4, with changes in the coverage percentage on each domain. The Design for Organizational Complexity domain was renamed to Design Solutions for Organizational Complexity, and its exam coverage was bumped up from 12.5% to 26% while the Migration Planning domain was upgraded from 15% to 20% and was also renamed to Accelerate Workload Migration & Modernization. Speaking of Modernization, expect to see a lot of containerized architectures in the exam, which involves Kubernetes, Amazon ECS, Amazon EKS, Serverless, and other related services.

You can also see here that the Cost Control domain was removed. Don't think that there will be no cost-related questions in the exam. It only means that the cost factor has been distributed to other exam domains. So, for example, the Design Solutions for Organizational Complexity domain includes cost management and billing setup topics for multi-account AWS environments using AWS Organizations. The exam coverage for the Design for New Solutions domain was reduced from 31% to 29% only. The same goes for the Continuous Improvement domain, which was at 29% before but is now at 25%, including a slight name change to "Continuous Improvement for Existing Solutions" as well.



Exam Topics for SAP-C02

This list of the AWS services covered for the AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional exam is quite long which simply proves how wide the topics are covered in the test. Don't get scared by the sheer length of the list but rather, start by reviewing the AWS services based on its section. With proper training and study strategy, you would be able to adequately cover these topics on your review:

Analytics:

- Amazon Athena
- AWS Data Exchange
- Amazon EMR
- AWS Glue
- Amazon Managed Service for Apache Flink Studio
- Amazon Data Firehose
- Amazon Kinesis Data Streams
- AWS Lake Formation
- Amazon Managed Streaming for Apache Kafka (Amazon MSK)
- Amazon OpenSearch Service
- Amazon Quick

Application Integration:

- Amazon AppFlow
- AWS AppSync
- Amazon EventBridge (Amazon CloudWatch Events)
- Amazon MQ
- Amazon Simple Notification Service (Amazon SNS)
- Amazon Simple Queue Service (Amazon SQS)
- AWS Step Functions

Business Applications:

- Alexa for Business
- Amazon Simple Email Service (Amazon SES)

Blockchain:

- Amazon Managed Blockchain

Machine Learning:

- Amazon Comprehend
- Amazon Fraud Detector
- Amazon Kendra
- Amazon Lex
- Amazon Personalize
- Amazon Polly
- Amazon Rekognition
- Amazon SageMaker AI
- Amazon Textract
- Amazon Transcribe
- Amazon Translate

Management and Governance:

- AWS CloudFormation
- AWS CloudTrail
- Amazon CloudWatch
- Amazon CloudWatch Logs
- AWS Command Line Interface (AWS CLI)
- AWS Compute Optimizer
- AWS Config
- AWS Control Tower
- AWS License Manager
- Amazon Managed Grafana
- Amazon Managed Service for Prometheus
- AWS Management Console
- AWS Organizations
- AWS Personal Health Dashboard
- AWS Proton
- AWS Service Catalog
- Service Quotas
- AWS Systems Manager
- AWS Trusted Advisor
- AWS Well-Architected Tool

**Cloud Financial Management:**

AWS Budgets
AWS Cost and Usage Report
AWS Cost Explorer
Savings Plans

Compute:

AWS App Runner
AWS Auto Scaling
AWS Batch
Amazon EC2
Amazon EC2 Auto Scaling
AWS Elastic Beanstalk
Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service (Amazon EKS)
Elastic Load Balancing
AWS Fargate
AWS Lambda
Amazon Lightsail
AWS Outposts
AWS Wavelength

Containers:

Amazon Elastic Container Registry (Amazon ECR)
Amazon Elastic Container Service (Amazon ECS)
Amazon ECS Anywhere
Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service (Amazon EKS)
Amazon EKS Anywhere
Amazon EKS Distro

Database:

Amazon Aurora
Amazon Aurora Serverless
Amazon DocumentDB (with MongoDB compatibility)
Amazon DynamoDB
Amazon ElastiCache
Amazon Keyspaces (for Apache Cassandra)
Amazon Neptune
Amazon RDS
Amazon Redshift
Amazon Timestream

Migration and Transfer:

AWS Application Discovery Service
AWS Application Migration Service (AWS MGN)
AWS Database Migration Service (AWS DMS)
AWS DataSync
AWS Migration Hub
AWS Schema Conversion Tool (AWS SCT)
AWS Transfer Family

Security, Identity, and Compliance:

AWS Artifact
AWS Audit Manager
AWS Certificate Manager (ACM)
AWS CloudHSM
Amazon Cognito
Amazon Detective
AWS Directory Service
AWS Firewall Manager
Amazon GuardDuty
AWS Identity and Access Management (IAM)
Amazon Inspector
AWS Key Management Service (AWS KMS)
Amazon Macie
AWS Network Firewall
AWS Resource Access Manager (AWS RAM)
AWS Secrets Manager
AWS Security Hub
AWS Security Token Service (AWS STS)
AWS Shield
AWS IAM Identity Center
AWS WAF

Media Services:

- Amazon Elastic Transcoder
- Amazon Kinesis Video Streams

**Developer Tools:**

AWS CodeArtifact
AWS CodeBuild
AWS CodeDeploy
Amazon CodeGuru
AWS CodePipeline
AWS X-Ray

Frontend Web and Mobile:

AWS Amplify
Amazon API Gateway
AWS Device Farm
Amazon Pinpoint

Internet of Things:

AWS IoT Core
AWS IoT Device Defender
AWS IoT Device Management
AWS IoT Events
AWS IoT Greengrass
AWS IoT SiteWise
AWS IoT Things Graph
AWS IoT 1-Click

Networking and Content Delivery:

- Amazon CloudFront
- AWS Direct Connect
- Elastic Load Balancing (ELB)
- AWS Global Accelerator
- AWS PrivateLink
- Amazon Route 53
- AWS Transit Gateway
- Amazon VPC
- AWS VPN

Storage:

- AWS Backup
- Amazon Elastic Block Store (Amazon EBS)
- AWS Elastic Disaster Recovery (CloudEndure Disaster Recovery)
- Amazon Elastic File System (Amazon EFS)
- Amazon FSx (for all types)
- Amazon S3
- Amazon S3 Glacier
- AWS Storage Gateway

End User Computing:

- Amazon AppStream 2.0
- Amazon WorkSpaces



Exam Scoring System

You can get a score from 100 to 1,000 with a minimum passing score of **750** when you take the Solutions Architect Professional exam. AWS uses a scaled scoring model to equate scores across multiple exam types that may have different difficulty levels. The complete score report will be sent to you by email after a few days.

Individuals who unfortunately do not pass the AWS exam must wait 14 days before they are allowed to retake the exam. Fortunately, there is no hard limit on exam attempts until you pass the exam. Take note that on each attempt, the full registration price of the AWS exam must be paid. Within 5 business days of completing your exam, your AWS Certification Account will have a record of your complete exam results.

Section	Score Performance		
	% of Scored Items	Needs Improvement	Meets Competencies
Domain 1: Design Solutions for Organizational Complexity	26%		
Domain 2: Design for New Solutions	29%		
Domain 3: Continuous Improvement for Existing Solutions	25%		
Domain 4: Accelerate Workload Migration and Modernization	20%		

Disclaimer: AWS Certification exams are designed to make pass/fail decisions based on the total exam score. Section level results are designed to provide direction on areas where a candidate may be weak. Candidates should exercise caution when interpreting the above section level score information as it is less reliable than the total exam score and not intended to guide future test performance.



The score report, as shown above, contains a table of your performance at each section/domain, which indicates whether you met the competency level required for these domains or not. AWS uses a compensatory scoring model, which means that you do not necessarily need to pass each and every individual section, only the overall examination. Each section has a specific score weighting that translates to the number of questions; hence, some sections have more questions than others. The Score Performance table highlights your strengths and weaknesses that you need to improve on.



Exam Benefits

If you successfully passed any AWS exam, you will be eligible for the following benefits:

- **Exam Discount** - You'll get a 50% discount voucher that you can apply for your recertification or any other exam you plan to pursue. To access your discount voucher code, go to the "Benefits" section of your AWS Certification Account, and apply the voucher when you register for your next exam.
- **Certification Digital Badges** - You can showcase your achievements to your colleagues and employers with digital badges on your email signatures, LinkedIn profile, or on your social media accounts. You can also show your Digital Badge to gain exclusive access to Certification Lounges at AWS re:Invent, regional Appreciation Receptions, and select AWS Summit events. To view your badges, simply go to the "Digital Badges" section of your AWS Certification Account.

You can visit the official AWS Certification FAQ page to view the frequently asked questions about getting AWS Certified and other information about the AWS Certification: <https://aws.amazon.com/certification/faqs/>.